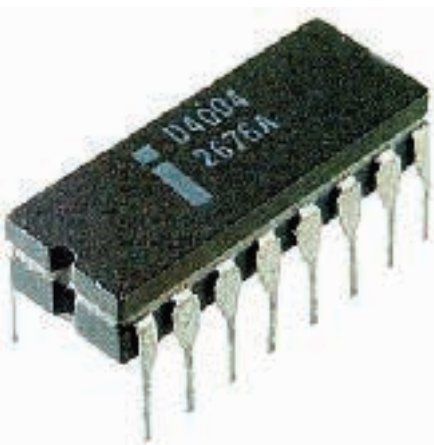


However Busicom never produced a product using 4004. In a clever move, Intel bought back the design and marketing rights from Busicom. With rapid development in semiconductor electronics, soon 8-bit, 16-bit, 32-bit and 64-bit microprocessors were developed. IBM selected the Intel 8088 for the first PC in 1981. In about a quarter of a century, modern computing reached sky high speeds.



However the speed of the microprocessor is limited by the main memory access time. Today we use multiple processors (or cores) to improve a computer's performance. Dual-core, quad-core processors are common among personal computers, while six, eight, ten, twelve and sixteen-core processors are more expensive and used in professional workstations. It's speculated that within 5 to 10 years, Intel will be able to fit 50 or so cores on a single chip with a 100 simultaneous threads.

Mobile Phone

One of the finest movies of Hindi cinema, Don has a car chase scene across the island city of Mumbai. Watching a movie made during those days makes you want to sit up and take notice of all that has changed over the decades- the cars, fashion and music sense, infrastructure, lack of people on the roads and most of all, the lack of mobile phones. You'll be hard-pressed to find yourself at a smartphone-free live concert of any sort these days.

Mobile phones (or 'mobiles' as we call them) literally brought about a sea of change. We no longer have to wait near a landline telephone for important calls. This round-the-clock companion has grown into a powerful assistant. Right from providing utilities such as alarm clocks and torch lights to entertainment options such as music and video and support for communication via voice calls, video calls, SMS, email and VoIP telephony, we've started using mobile phones for more than what they were invented for.

We've come a long way since 1946 when for the first time mobile phone